

Asian Houbara (*Chlamydotis macqueenii*) - Field Guide

1. Species Overview

The Asian Houbara is a large bird in the bustard family. It breeds in deserts and semi-deserts across Asia, from the Sinai Peninsula east to Mongolia, and winters in the Arabian Peninsula and Southwest Asia.

2. Habitat Requirements

They prefer arid regions with sparse vegetation. The HoubaraTracker uses Google Earth Engine to calculate SAVI (Soil Adjusted Vegetation Index) which is critical for identifying optimal habitats.

3. Migration Patterns

Using satellite telemetry, we track three main migration corridors. The birds exhibit high site fidelity, often returning to the exact same breeding and wintering grounds annually.